

1 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Which toy disappeared?

What we are practising

Observe a small set and recall a change.

What you need

Large toy car / Soft toy / Large spoon / Towel

Use any three large, clearly different safe objects.

Before you begin

Place the three objects in a row and name them.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Look at the objects together for a few moments.
2. Ask the child to look away while you hide the spoon under the towel.
3. Ask what changed, reveal the spoon, then swap roles.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What was here before but is not here now?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Sort it your way

What we are practising

Group objects using one consistent feature.

What you need

Two soft toys / Two rolled towels / Two large rigid toy blocks

Use large household objects with clearly different textures.

Before you begin

Check that the blocks have smooth edges.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Feel each object and discuss soft and hard.
2. Put the soft items in one group and hard items in another.
3. Mix them again and invite a different rule, such as toys and towels.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How can you tell me why this belongs here?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Clap, tap, what comes next?

What we are practising

Notice and continue a two-part repeating sequence.

What you need

No materials

Use two hand gestures silently if preferred.

Before you begin

Choose two comfortable actions, such as clapping and tapping a knee.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Demonstrate clap, tap, clap, tap slowly.
2. Pause after the next clap and ask what comes next.
3. Repeat together, then let the child choose a new two-action pattern.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What little part keeps repeating?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Build a toy road

What we are practising

Try a route, notice a blockage and change the plan.

What you need

Large toy car / Three cushions / Soft toy destination

Move your finger along a drawn road on paper.

Before you begin

Set two cushions as road edges and one as an obstacle on the floor.

Play with hands on the floor; keep the route out of walking paths.

Try it together

1. Place the car at one end and the soft toy at the other.
2. Ask the child to drive without lifting the car over the obstacle.
3. If the route is blocked, move an edge cushion and test again.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Where could the car go around this cushion?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Repair the funny picture

What we are practising

Explain a mismatch using familiar everyday knowledge.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe the funny scene aloud instead of drawing.

Before you begin

Draw a child with shoes on their hands and bare feet.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Look at the picture together without naming the odd detail.
2. Ask what might make getting ready to walk tricky.
3. Let your child draw or describe a change, then invent a new silly scene.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Where would the shoes usually go for a walk?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

A chair for Bear

What we are practising

Use an empty-space clue to make a choice.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw three chairs: one with a cat, one with a rabbit, one empty.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw three chairs: one with a cat, one with a rabbit, one empty.
2. Ask: Bear needs a chair without moving anyone. Which chair can Bear use?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw three chairs: one with a cat, one with a rabbit, one empty. Bear needs a chair without moving anyone. Which chair can Bear use?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

The striped sock partner

What we are practising

Match a pattern despite a change of position.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw one striped sock and three choices: striped, dotted and plain.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw one striped sock and three choices: striped, dotted and plain.
2. Ask: Which choice makes a pair with the striped sock?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw one striped sock and three choices: striped, dotted and plain. Which choice makes a pair with the striped sock?

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

The wide toy doorway

What we are practising

Compare fit using a stated constraint.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a wide toy car, a narrow doorway and a doorway wider than the car.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw a wide toy car, a narrow doorway and a doorway wider than the car.
2. Ask: Which doorway lets the car pass without turning or squeezing it?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a wide toy car, a narrow doorway and a doorway wider than the car. Which doorway lets the car pass without turning or squeezing it?

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Before the hat

What we are practising

Identify a missing action in a short sequence.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a doll, a hat on the floor and the doll wearing the hat.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw a doll, a hat on the floor and the doll wearing the hat.
2. Ask: The hat starts on the floor. What must happen before the doll wears it?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a doll, a hat on the floor and the doll wearing the hat. The hat starts on the floor. What must happen before the doll wears it?

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

One cup still needed

What we are practising

Check one-to-one matching.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw three toy guests; put a cup beside two of them.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw three toy guests; put a cup beside two of them.
2. Ask: Every guest needs one cup. Who still needs a cup?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw three toy guests; put a cup beside two of them. Every guest needs one cup. Who still needs a cup?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Inside, not beside

What we are practising

Use a boundary to identify location.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a large box outline with a ball inside and a star beside it.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw a large box outline with a ball inside and a star beside it.
2. Ask: Which thing is inside the box?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a large box outline with a ball inside and a star beside it. Which thing is inside the box?

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Which path stops?

What we are practising

Follow a route and notice a dead end.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw two paths from a rabbit: one ends at a wall, one reaches a carrot.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw two paths from a rabbit: one ends at a wall, one reaches a carrot.
2. Ask: Which path reaches the carrot without crossing a wall?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw two paths from a rabbit: one ends at a wall, one reaches a carrot. Which path reaches the carrot without crossing a wall?

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

The two-piece face

What we are practising

Infer a missing part from a whole picture.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a face missing its mouth; show a smiling mouth and a spare ear.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw a face missing its mouth; show a smiling mouth and a spare ear.
2. Ask: Which piece fills the missing part of this face?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a face missing its mouth; show a smiling mouth and a spare ear. Which piece fills the missing part of this face?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

The towel's job

What we are practising

Choose a tool that matches a purpose.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw wet hands, a towel and a book.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw wet hands, a towel and a book.
2. Ask: Which choice is intended for drying the hands: the towel or the book?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw wet hands, a towel and a book. Which choice is intended for drying the hands: the towel or the book?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Same picture, turned around

What we are practising

Recognise an object after rotation.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a large arrow pointing up; turn the sheet so it points down.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw a large arrow pointing up; turn the sheet so it points down.
2. Ask: Did turning the paper make a new arrow, or move the same arrow?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a large arrow pointing up; turn the sheet so it points down. Did turning the paper make a new arrow, or move the same arrow?

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

The hidden choice

What we are practising

Notice when information is missing.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw two closed boxes with identical outsides; tell the child one contains a teddy.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw two closed boxes with identical outsides; tell the child one contains a teddy.
2. Ask: Can looking at these closed boxes tell us which has the teddy?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw two closed boxes with identical outsides; tell the child one contains a teddy. Can looking at these closed boxes tell us which has the teddy?

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

No room on top

What we are practising

Distinguish direct contact from above and below.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a tower with a wide block at the bottom and a narrow one on top.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw a tower with a wide block at the bottom and a narrow one on top.
2. Ask: Which block touches the floor?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a tower with a wide block at the bottom and a narrow one on top. Which block touches the floor?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

The red circle invitation

What we are practising

Combine two simple conditions.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a red circle, a blue circle and a red square.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw a red circle, a blue circle and a red square.
2. Ask: Only a red circle can enter this pretend party. Which shape can enter?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a red circle, a blue circle and a red square. Only a red circle can enter this pretend party. Which shape can enter?

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

The shoe is not a cup

What we are practising

Explain an everyday mismatch.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a shoe with juice in it beside an empty drinking cup.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw a shoe with juice in it beside an empty drinking cup.
2. Ask: For an ordinary drink, where should the juice be?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a shoe with juice in it beside an empty drinking cup. For an ordinary drink, where should the juice be?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

The ribbon behind the box

What we are practising

Infer a hidden continuation from a stated clue.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a ribbon entering behind a box on one side and emerging on the other; tell the child it is one unbroken ribbon.

An adult reads and draws with the child using age-appropriate drawing tools. Explore the situation in pictures.

Try it together

1. Draw a ribbon entering behind a box on one side and emerging on the other; tell the child it is one unbroken ribbon.
2. Ask: Is the middle of the ribbon missing, or hidden behind the box?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a ribbon entering behind a box on one side and emerging on the other; tell the child it is one unbroken ribbon. Is the middle of the ribbon missing, or hidden behind the box?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Which toy disappeared?

A little hint

Recall the object names aloud together.

Answer / what to notice

In the starter round, the spoon is missing.

Comparing the earlier group with the current one reveals the change.

Make it easier

Begin with two objects and leave their positions unchanged.

Take it further

Keep three objects but move one rather than hiding it.

Another day, away from the screen

Notice one change in a familiar room together.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Sort it your way

A little hint

Ask whether the new object follows the same rule as its neighbours.

Answer / what to notice

Several groupings work if every object follows the stated rule.

The same objects can form different groups when the rule changes.

Make it easier

Use only two soft objects and two hard blocks.

Take it further

Ask the child to make a group while you guess its rule.

Another day, away from the screen

Sort clean laundry by a child-chosen feature.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Clap, tap, what comes next?

A little hint

Say the pair aloud: clap, tap.

Answer / what to notice

A tap follows the clap in the starter pattern.

Repeating the same pair helps us predict the next action.

Make it easier

Copy one pair at a time with no guessing.

Take it further

Try clap, clap, tap as a three-action unit.

Another day, away from the screen

Make a repeating pattern while walking slowly together.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Build a toy road

A little hint

Look for a gap wider than the car.

Answer / what to notice

Any continuous route around the obstacle that fits the car works.

Testing a route shows whether the available space is wide enough.

Make it easier

Leave a clear wide gap to begin.

Take it further

Add a second obstacle and plan before moving.

Another day, away from the screen

Draw the successful route after clearing the floor.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Repair the funny picture

A little hint

Point to the feet and ask what is missing.

Answer / what to notice

For an ordinary walk, shoes usually go on feet; pretend play can use different rules.

Explaining why a detail is unusual is more useful than only calling it wrong.

Make it easier

Offer two choices for where to put the shoes.

Take it further

Draw a scene with two unusual details.

Another day, away from the screen

Make a funny bedtime scene and repair it together.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. A chair for Bear

A little hint

Look for a seat with nobody on it.

Answer / what to notice

The empty chair.

The other two chairs already have occupants; the empty one meets the rule.

Make it easier

Show only one full chair and one empty chair.

Take it further

Draw four chairs with two empty ones; find both possible answers.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. The striped sock partner

A little hint

Compare the marks, not where the socks are drawn.

Answer / what to notice

The other striped sock.

A pair in this game must have the same pattern.

Make it easier

Offer the striped and plain socks only.

Take it further

Add stripes in two colours and require both colour and pattern to match.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. The wide toy doorway

A little hint

Compare the car's width with each opening.

Answer / what to notice

The doorway wider than the car.

The narrow opening cannot fit the full width shown.

Make it easier

Trace the car's width with two fingers.

Take it further

Draw a doorway exactly the same width; discuss why real objects may need extra space.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. Before the hat

A little hint

The hat cannot move itself.

Answer / what to notice

Someone must lift the hat and put it on the doll.

Moving the hat connects the starting scene to the ending scene.

Make it easier

Act out lifting an imaginary hat.

Take it further

Tell the sequence backwards, from wearing the hat to finding it on the floor.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. One cup still needed

A little hint

Match one guest to one cup.

Answer / what to notice

The guest with no cup beside them.

Two guests are already matched; the remaining guest is not.

Make it easier

Use two guests, one with a cup.

Take it further

Give one guest two cups and another none; fix it by moving one cup.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. Inside, not beside

A little hint

Follow the box's boundary.

Answer / what to notice

The ball.

The ball lies within the boundary; the star lies outside it.

Make it easier

Colour the inside of the box lightly.

Take it further

Draw a second box inside the first and place a dot inside both.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. Which path stops?

A little hint

Trace each path with your finger.

Answer / what to notice

The path that ends at the carrot.

A path ending at the wall cannot continue under this rule.

Make it easier

Trace the blocked path together first.

Take it further

Add a branch that loops back to the start; find the useful branch.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. The two-piece face

A little hint

Look below the nose.

Answer / what to notice

The mouth.

The face already has ears but lacks the mouth in the usual position.

Make it easier

Point to your own mouth while naming it.

Take it further

Draw a face with two missing parts and name both.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. The towel's job

A little hint

Think about what we use after washing.

Answer / what to notice

The towel.

A towel is made for drying; using the book would damage it.

Make it easier

Mime drying your hands.

Take it further

Find two different tools for carrying water and explain their shared purpose.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. Same picture, turned around

A little hint

Watch the arrow throughout the turn.

Answer / what to notice

It moved the same arrow.

Direction changed, but nothing was added or removed.

Make it easier

Turn the sheet slowly together.

Take it further

Predict which way it will point after another half-turn.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. The hidden choice

A little hint

We have no clue about either inside.

Answer / what to notice

No; we need another clue or permission to look inside.

Identical outside pictures do not reveal their contents.

Make it easier

Say that guessing and knowing are different.

Take it further

Invent one helpful clue, such as “the teddy is in the box with a star”.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. No room on top

A little hint

Start at the floor line.

Answer / what to notice

The wide bottom block.

The upper block rests on the lower block, not directly on the floor.

Make it easier

Use only two large rectangles in the drawing.

Take it further

Add a middle block and identify what each block touches.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. The red circle invitation

A little hint

Check both colour and shape.

Answer / what to notice

The red circle.

The blue circle has the wrong colour; the red square has the wrong shape.

Make it easier

Name each choice's colour and shape together.

Take it further

Change the invitation to “anything red”; identify the two guests now allowed.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. The shoe is not a cup

A little hint

Choose the object designed for drinking.

Answer / what to notice

In a clean drinking cup.

The imagined scene puts a drink in an unsuitable container; this is a picture puzzle, not a tasting game.

Make it easier

Offer only the cup as the replacement.

Take it further

Invent a different funny mismatch and explain how to fix it.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. The ribbon behind the box

A little hint

One unbroken ribbon joins the two visible ends.

Answer / what to notice

It is hidden behind the box.

The box blocks our view of the middle; the clue says the ribbon is continuous.

Make it easier

Draw the covered middle with a dotted line.

Take it further

Remove the unbroken-ribbon clue and discuss whether we can know what is behind the box.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.